

Part 1

Read Passage One and answer questions 1-5 on the Question-Answer Book.

Passage One:

Follow your nose

- 1 [1] Our memory of a smell is more long lasting and reliable than that of sight or taste. If there were no smells or odours, we would find it difficult to identify various objects. Olfaction – the sense of smell – determines many things, ranging from our shopping preferences to our compatibility with others. Studies conducted by social anthropologist Kate Fox show that olfaction and emotions in human beings are connected, and that odours can trigger strong emotional responses. Smells influence us no less than what we see and hear.
- 5 [2] We often exclaim, "This dish is delicious!" when trying food. But do you know it is our sense of smell and not our taste buds that first help us to determine the taste. When food enters the mouth, the chemical substances in it spread to the olfactory region. It is then that we get a taste of what we have eaten. This accounts for why many of us lose our appetite when we lose our olfactory ability. It is no wonder that those who have the flu do not feel like eating because they cannot taste food. How dull would life be if one could not smell!
- 10 [3] We are easily influenced by what we see. A person's appearance is a primary factor in people's choice of companions. You might be surprised to know that olfaction unconsciously affects our choice of life partners. Our olfaction can distinguish genes that have reactions to our own immunisation. By means of pheromones, humans can determine whose genes have immunisation reactions that can match our own genes.
- 15 [4] The influence of smell on humans has made 'scent marketing' an implicit part of sales strategies. For scent marketing to be effective in influencing consumer choices, scents need to be synonymous with products or an industry. For example, some sports items could smell of grass, making customers associate them with running on grass.
- 20 [5] Human beings rely heavily on their eyes and ears to see and hear. This has led to the evolution of audio and visual entertainment. But now it is time for odour to be injected into the virtual world. An example is the 3D theatre in Disneyland. The fragrance of fruits often accompanies many film screenings.
- 25 [6] Researchers at the University of Birmingham in the United Kingdom are investigating a new technology, Scent Delivery System, that can mingle odours with TV games. It will allow video game players to experience the four senses of sight, hearing, touch and olfaction while playing. The special chemical substances in the system are modelled on the odours that would normally be associated with what is happening in a scene. For example, in a shooting game, the smell of gunpowder could be used.
- [7] Humans have little understanding of the significance of olfaction. Losing our ability to smell can be dangerous. If we cannot smell, we will not know when a food item has turned bad. We will be unable to detect life-threatening gas leaks and other hazardous odours.
- 30 [8] Unlike animals, human beings do not rely on olfaction to identify enemies. But a bigger familiarity with smells can improve our understanding of life. What we see should not solely determine our experiences of life. Sometimes if we let olfaction take control, we discover more.

Read Passage Two and answer questions 6-15 on the Question-Answer Book.

Passage Two:

Tucked away in an alley in Hong Kong, this tiny 46 sq ft space plays a big part in the local arts scene

- 1 [1] The intersection of a street between Wan Chai and Causeway Bay used to look like any other alley in Hong Kong: dark, dirty and forgotten. That was until Him Lo, 40, decided to turn the corner into something more visually pleasing and meaningful.
- 5 [2] Inside the narrow, 46-sq-ft space sits Window and Alley, one of the smallest shops and most captivating shops in Hong Kong. It is a work of art on its own, and it casts a stark visual contrast against the streets of Causeway Bay.
- 10 [3] The project started as an experiment to explore the use of small spaces. It is beautifully designed to accommodate the works of more than 100 Hong Kong artists and artisans. From homemade sourdough bagels made with Chinese traditional preserved fruits to hand-drawn recipes, the store has many facets of artistic expression all covered under one tiny roof.
- [4] "People's consumption habits have changed," said Lo, one of the three founders. He added that many people work from home and shop online nowadays. It remains a question whether people are willing to go to physical stores. "But since our products aren't mass-produced, there are still many people who come to our store to check out what's new or peculiar in their free time," he continued.
- 15 [5] Roaming around the city has always been a pastime for Lo and another co-founder, artist Samson Wong Yu-hin, who also started the YouTube channel, "When in doubt, take a walk". The channel promotes the joy of strolling through the city's nooks and alleys, appreciating the unique urban surroundings that, at first glance, appear mundane and inconsequential.
- 20 [6] The artist also uses the tiny space to run a workshop called "City Record Workshop," which encourages people from all walks of life to record the city's past and present, from major happenings to everyday things they find interesting about life in the city, and gives them tips on how to better observe and describe these events.
- [7] In addition, Lo has recently placed a truck at the Hong Kong Institute of Contemporary Culture Lee Shau Kee School of Creativity. Not only is it a space where students can make donations, but it also serves as an internship programme for the school. Lo uses it to bring students to art hubs like Central Market to experience first-hand what it is like to run a store.
- 25 [8] When asked which piece in his store he found the most interesting, Lo pointed to a project called "First Time Cook This Dish," launched by a woman in her 20s and illustrated by a local artist who draws pictures of the dishes by hand.
- [9] She interviewed people from Hong Kong to find out about their favourite foods from when they were growing up. Then, together with the interviewees, she would shop for ingredients at the wet market, cook the dishes, and talk about how the city has changed.
- 30 [10] Her art is one example of how artists struggle to make money with their masterpieces, Lo said. Many other artists in the city have this same problem, and still work full-time jobs in order to fund their passion. Lo can relate, as he works full-time as a curator in some of the city's major art hubs, while managing the store part-time.
- 35 [11] On the plus side, the local art scene is now booming, mainly because people have no other choice, Lo said. "You stay [in Hong Kong], but you're not satisfied with the status quo. You want to do something within your capabilities; after all, you need to make a living. You have no choice but to find these little spaces and seams to survive. Hopefully it can change people's minds and show that some people haven't given up yet. We can do something for those who choose to stay in the city."

END OF READING PASSAGES

**FORM 2****GENERAL ENGLISH****QUESTION-ANSWER BOOK**

Name: _____

Class: _____

Class Number: _____

Set 4**Part 1 – Reading Comprehension (30 marks)****For each multiple-choice question, darken the appropriate circle. Otherwise, no mark will be awarded.****Passage One (14 marks)**

1. Does the writer think smell plays an important role in life? Quote a sentence from Paragraph 2 to support your answer.

2. According to Paragraph 3, what is the name of the substance that helps people choose their partners?

3. Find a word in paragraphs 3 to 7 which shares the same meaning as each of the phrases below. (4 marks)

(i) most important _____

(ii) without being aware _____

(iii) suggested without being directly expressed _____

(iv) closely connected _____

4. Use the information in the article to decide whether the following statements are True, False or Not Given. (3 marks)

	T	F	NG
(i) If you do not have any appetite, you must have the flu.	☐	☐	☐
(ii) People only make decisions based on what they see.	☐	☐	☐
(iii) Smelling gunpowder in a shooting game is dangerous.	☐	☐	☐

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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5. Match the headings to the corresponding paragraphs. Write the letters (A-F) next to each paragraph. One heading is not used. (5 marks)

Heading
A. Sniff out a mate
B. The impact of the loss of smell
C. Smell and taste link
D. The benefit of relying on smell
E. Scent in TV games
F. Scent marketing

Paragraph	
2	
3	
4	
6	
7	

Passage Two (16 marks)

6. According to Paragraph 2, what is the size of Window and Alley?

7. Which word in Paragraph 3 means people who do skilled work with their hands?

8. According to Paragraph 4, what is special about the goods sold at Window and Alley?

9. Find a word or phrase in Paragraph 5 that means walking somewhere in a slow and relaxed way.

10. Which phrase in Paragraph 6 refers to people's social status or backgrounds?

11. Why has Lo recently placed a truck at the Hong Kong Institute of Contemporary Culture Lee Shau Kee School of Creativity?

- (i) to collect donation from students
- (ii) to promote Window and Alley to students
- (iii) to give students the opportunity to try running a stall
- (iv) to bring students to explore the city's nooks and alleys

- A. (ii) only
- B. (i) and (ii) only
- C. (ii) and (iii) only
- D. (iii) and (iv) only

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

12. What does 'the status quo' (line 36) mean?

- A. the amount of respect given to a person
- B. the current situation
- C. the official position in a social group
- D. the information that someone publish about oneself on a social media website

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

13. What is the tone of Lo regarding the future of the city in Paragraph 11?

- A. Optimistic
- B. Pessimistic
- C. Neutral
- D. Undecided

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

14. Use the information in the article to decide whether the following statements are True, False or Not Given.

(4 marks)

- (i) Window and Alley only sells paintings and drawings.
- (ii) Lo thinks people nowadays are not willing to go to physical stores.
- (iii) A lot of artists cannot earn a living doing art and have to find other jobs to allow them to pursue their dreams.
- (iv) Lo spends more time at the shop than in the workplace of his full-time job.

T F NG
☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐
☐ ☐ ☐

15. Brian is writing an article on Window and Alley. Please help him complete the following paragraph. Use only ONE word in each blank. Make sure your answers are grammatically correct.

(4 marks)

A 20-year-old woman started a project called "First Time Cook This Dish". To gather ideas, she would

- (i) _____ people and ask them about their favourite childhood food. After that, they would go to the wet market and get the (ii) _____ they needed. Next, they prepared the (iii) _____ together and discussed the transformation of the city. Finally, the meals were illustrated with (iv) _____ pictures.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

END OF PART 1

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Part 2 – English Usage (70 marks)

A. Verb Forms (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the words provided in brackets in their correct forms.

Follow your dream

Santiago, a shepherd boy in Andalusia, (1) (lead) a simple life. Every day he takes care of his flock of sheep and walks around the villages. One day, he has a mysterious dream of Egyptian pyramids and treasure. He doesn't know anything about the pyramids but he is interested in (2) (find) out about them. So he consults a fortune teller who suggests that he should go to a pyramid to find his treasure.

The dream changes Santiago's life. After the consultation, he meets a man who claims to be the king of Salem. He too urges the boy (3) (find) the treasure and achieve his 'personal legend'.

"To realise one's destiny is a person's only obligation," the king tells him. "And, when you want something, all the universe conspires to help you to achieve it."

In the story, a personal legend is your goal in life, your reason for being. Santiago is not sure about (4) (go) on this treasure hunt, as he is in love with a merchant's daughter. However, after a long struggle, he sells all of his sheep to fund his journey.

Unfortunately, during his journey through a foreign country, he has all of his money stolen by a thief. Undeterred, he masters the local language and learns about business after working for a year at a crystal merchant's shop.

He now has enough money to return home, but on the way he has a strange encounter with an Englishman who says he (5) (search) for the alchemist. The man's passion inspires Santiago to fulfil his own dream and he sets off once again for the pyramids.

In the pursuit of his personal legend, he realises that he has to listen to his heart rather than his mind. Finally he meets the alchemist who helps him to overcome his obstacles and discover the treasure where he least (6) (expect) to find it.

Written by the Brazilian writer Paulo Coelho, the book (7) (sell) more than 100 million copies and has been translated into 67 languages. *The Alchemist* is a book that everyone should read. It (8) (write) like a fairy tale and uses simple but effective language.

You may have already read this book, since it (9) (publish) nearly 30 years ago. But even if that is the case, you should reread it – a good book deserves (10) (read) over and over again!

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

B. Vocabulary (5 marks)

Choose the most suitable words from the table below to complete the sentences. You may need to change the form of the words to fit the sentence. Each word or phrase should only be used **once**.

vulnerability	extinction	squat down
disaster	raise money	illegality
endanger	donate	campaigner

There are many organisations in the world dedicated to the protection of (1) species. A lot of animal habitats have been destroyed as a result of (2) deforestation. If the situation keeps worsening, it will have a (3) impact on nature. Save the Animals is going to hold their annual charity auctions to (4) for the work they do. They are going to launch a conservation (5) aiming to protect African forest elephants.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

C. Parts of Speech (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the appropriate forms of the words in brackets.

Taxing the fat

(1) (Obese) is becoming endemic across the globe and costing countries a huge amount in public health expenses each year. In what may seem like a drastic measure, a worldwide trend to impose taxes on (2) (fat) food is emerging with Denmark at the helm.

Denmark has implemented the world's first tax (3) (specific) on fat content. The government act came into effect last month and imposes an additional charge on food containing saturated fats exceeding 2.3 percent. This includes butter, pizza and even milk. The Danish government hopes that by raising the price of foods with high fat content, consumers' desire to buy and devour it will be lowered, and so will instances of obesity. This action has induced other countries to follow suit.

Less than 10 per cent of the Danish population is (4) (clinic) obese. But the Danish government wants to minimise the health problems and financial burden brought upon the country and its population by obesity – a medical condition that is (5) (avoid). The introduction of the 'fat tax' is a preventive measure, both to alleviate the current situation and avoid it becoming worse. The spread of obesity is endemic throughout the world, making what is already an appalling situation, worse.

The global rise in overweight people and obesity is referred to as 'globesity' by the World Health Organisation. Using the average Europeans' Body Mass Index (BMI) as a standard, those with a BMI greater than 25 are considered overweight. Those with a BMI over 30 are obese. Globesity leads to the (6) (dead) of about seven percent of the world's population each year. It is among the top five (7) (prevent) causes of death. Hence, globesity exerts a huge strain on the public health services of the world.

Overconsumption of saturated fats is the main cause of obesity. The direct correlation between cardiovascular diseases and saturated fat intake has been medically proven. Saturated fat can increase levels of 'bad' cholesterol particles in the body, and produce fat lumps in the blood vessels which cause (8) (block). The obstruction of blood vessels can then trigger heart blood vessel diseases. Obesity is the cause of about three million (9) (dead) cases of cardiovascular diseases, diabetes and cancer each year according to WHO estimates.

If a significant portion of the population is obese, the financial strain on public health facilities becomes enormous. This makes economic advancement and financial (10) (stable) harder to achieve. It uses up public funds and facilities which may be in short supply and required for help in other areas, and is funded by taxpayers who are not obese.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

D. Modal Verbs (5 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the modal verbs provided in the table below. Each modal verb can be used more than once.

might	might not	can	cannot
ought	ought not	must	must not

A middle-aged couple was caught on camera shoving aside a young school girl queuing at a Lok Fu bus stop. When a passenger reprimanded them, the couple shouted abuse at her for over ten minutes. Enraged by the couple's outrageous conduct, other passengers spoke up. The entire drama was captured on video and posted on YouTube, where it was quickly viewed by thousands. Many online were critical of the couple's uncivilised behaviour.

The 'Bus Uncle' video on YouTube a few years ago – in which a middle-age man hurled abuse at a young man on a bus – started a wave of online videos uploaded on the internet showing people being caught acting badly in public.

Associate professor Denny Ho Kwok-leung from the Hong Kong Polytechnic University Department of Applied Social Sciences said that posting such videos was a reflection of society's prevailing values, such as the collective view that people (1) to queue up at a bus stop.

Rule-breakers these days are not only reprimanded on the spot, but (2) have their shameful conduct exposed to the world through online videos. The actions are usually obnoxious but do not amount to actual law breaking, so the police (3) serve justice in these cases.

Posting videos on the web allows people to put the culprits 'on trial' by laying out their wrongdoings for the public to see, and letting the public pass a collective judgement. The postings (4) lead to the exposure of the wrongdoers' identities, and subject them to public reproach.

When taking pictures and videos and posting them on the web, however, we must remember not to expose ourselves to danger or hurt others. We (5) also consider whether our actions are in the best interests of the public, and make sure that we are not breaking the law.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

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Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

E. Prepositions (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the correct prepositions.

A chef who worked (1) a popular fast food chain brought angry comments upon himself (2) his video of him making fried rice with a cleaning brush instead (3) a spatula, describing it as a creative cooking technique that "brings perfection to every grain of rice." Many viewers were repulsed (4) the video, and food safety concerns were raised.

The chef later explained (5) an online forum that he was just "fooling around" and did not actually serve the rice to anyone. But many thought this was not good justification (6) his conduct.

As a chef, he is responsible (7) the food customers eat. By posting the video, he may have been attempting (8) show (9) what he perceives as power (10) others.

1.	2.	3.
4.	5.	6.
7.	8.	9.
10.		

F. Multiple-choice Cloze (10 marks)

Read the following text. Decide which of the choices would best complete the text if inserted in the blanks. Write the **letter** of each answer in the space provided.

Mental state of play

The (1) poet Sylvia Plath drew on many events in her own life to write this novel. She too had been suffering from mental illness, but, unlike the main character, she could not handle it. Today, she is respected by feminists who draw inspiration from this novel.

Esther Greenwood is a bright college student who has won an internship as a guest editor for a women's magazine. She and 11 other girls are (2) to have a great time in New York working in an exciting environment during the day and going to parties at night. But Esther does not have (3) enthusiasm for the work and feels empty living in New York. When she thinks of her boyfriend, Buddy, it makes her even more depressed. He is a handsome young man, and her friends and family think he is perfect for her. But she does not want to give up her writing ambitions just to be an obedient (4).

She returns home to Boston and decides to spend the summer with her mother, who puts pressure on her to get married, keep a tidy home and (5) a family. Esther cannot decide whether she should (6) her dream of being a poet or conform to everyone's expectations.

Her depression gets worse so her mother takes her to see an uncaring male doctor who gives her electric shock therapy (a series of electric shocks to the brain). This only makes matters worse and Esther becomes suicidal. Luckily she is saved just in time and enters a mental institution. The first hospital does little to improve her condition, but then she is transferred to a private hospital and cared for by Dr Nolan, a female doctor who is more (7) towards her mental state.

With Dr Nolan's help, Esther's mental illness is treated and she realises there is much to look forward (8) in life. She learns that suicide is wrong and that problems in life can be overcome. But she does question if "the bell jar, with its stifling distortions, wouldn't descend again?"

Plath challenged the (9) idea that women have to get married, stay at home and (10) children. Esther wants to be a writer but her family thinks she is being silly. She also believed that society did not treat both sexes fairly – Buddy was seeing another girl while he was dating Esther but that is easily forgiven because he is a man. If a woman tried to do that, it would have been unforgivable.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

1. A. trouble B. troubling C. troubled D. troublesome	2. A. experienced B. experiencing C. expected D. expect	3. A. many B. much C. a lot D. little
4. A. breadwinner B. breadtaker C. homedoor D. housewife	5. A. have B. having C. to have D. half	6. A. puruse B. pursue C. perusal D. perusual
7. A. sympathy B. sympathier C. sympathetic D. sympatheticer	8. A. to B. in C. on D. for	9. A. tradition B. conventional C. innovative D. avant-garde
10. A. raise B. rise C. rose D. raisin		

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
6.	7.	8.	9.	10.

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G. Sentence Transformation (10 marks)

Rewrite the following sentences as instructed without changing the meaning.

1. I was sleepy. I fell asleep on the bus and missed my stop. (Combine the sentences using "so... that")

2. The whole class heard a joke and burst into laughter. (Rewrite using the present participle)

3. Yesterday's football match was called off since it was raining heavily. (Rewrite using "because of")

4. "Yes, I cheated in the exam," Frankie said to me. (Use reported speech with the reporting verb "admit")

5. Jeannette is sweeping the floor now. (Rewrite the sentence in the opposite voice)

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H. Proofreading (10 marks)

Proofread the following text (numbered lines 1-10 only) without changing the meaning. No lines have more than one mistake and at least one line is correct. Do not make any changes to punctuation and do not make unnecessary changes. Use ONE word only for each correction. If you think there are no mistakes in a line, put a ✓ at the end of the line (example c).

Corrections must be done as follows:

Extra word: delete the extra word with a 'X' (example a).

Missing word: mark the position of the missing word with a '^' and write the missing word above it (example b).

Wrong word: underline the wrong word and write the correct word above it (example d).

- | | |
|---|--|
| a | When I was younger, my friends and I would X try to scare each other |
| b | by telling ghost stories. I never got frightened because I did not believe ^ ghosts. |
| c | In fact, I would laugh at anyone who said they did. However, I changed my ✓ |
| d | mind about this last summer when I was staying <u>at</u> my aunt in Guangzhou. |

- 1 These days, people upload photos and videos of most mundane and bizarre details of life: the food they
- 2 are about to eat, their facial expressions when they are stuck in traffic, the odd pair of sock they have on.
- 3 To a lot of people, this behaviour is bordering on madness, but the fact of the matter is that it is becoming
- 4 the norm in today's society. Sometimes misguided people post appropriate or illegal things, causing a
- 5 negative reaction and backlash. The reasons people expose their actions to this kind of scrutiny is manifold.
- 6 Encouraged by the now infamous 'Bus Uncle' video – where a middle-aged man's uncivilisation
- 7 actions on a bus were uploaded and reprimanded by society – people nowadays often assume 'reporter'
- 8 and 'judge' roles by uploading videos to expose things that are not right. Others seek for approval or want
- 9 to build an image of themselves by sharing videos about their children and activities they do like
- 10 eat, shopping or travelling. However, we should respect other people's privacy as well.

END OF PAPER

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.